SSC CGL 2019 Tier-I question paper with answers

3 March 2020 · Shift 2

49 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +2 for a right answer, –0.50 for a wrong one

The other 51 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20200710213341/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/Final_Answer_key%20cgle19t1.pdf

General Awareness 25 questions

Q.1
What was India's position in the Brand Finance Nation ranking of 2019?

(A) Seventh
(B) Fifth
(C) Third
(D) Sixth

Q.2
Who among the following was the last ruler of the Nanda dynasty?

(A) Dhanananda
(B) Kaivarta
(C) Panduka
(D) Govishanaka

Q.3
Which of the following was previously known as 'the Lady Willingdon Park'?

(A) Lodhi Gardens
(B) Mughal Gardens
(C) Deer Park
(D) Buddha Jayanti Park

Q.4
'Industry 4.0' is a complex cyber-physical system which synergies production with digital technologies. The Ministry of Railways and the Department of Science and Technology have joined hands in partnership with which institution for taking up a unique project on 'Industry 4.0'?

(A) IIT Bombay
(B) IIT Kanpur
(C) IIT Madras
(D) IIT Delhi

Q.5
In January 2020, Home Minister Amit Shah released a book ‘Karmayoddha Granth’. This book is based on the life of _____.

(A) Mahatma Gandhi
(B) Narendra Modi
(C) Jawaharlal Nehru
(D) Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel

Q.6
Ajatashatru, a ruler of the Haryanka Dynasty, was the son of _____.

(A) Anurudha
(B) Bimbisara
(C) Naga-Dasak
(D) Udayin

Q.7
In which state has the Khadi and Village Industries Commission (KVIC) opened the first silk processing plant?

(A) Maharashtra
(B) Karnataka
(C) Gujarat
(D) Tamil Nadu

Q.8
Borra caves are situated on the East Coast of India in which of the following hills?

(A) Nallamala Hills
(B) Nagari Hills
(C) Ananthagiri Hill
(D) Horsley Hills

Q.9
Objects that shine in the night sky are known as:

(A) meteoroids
(B) constellations
(C) celestial bodies
(D) asteroids

Q.10
Which law of physics states that the force between the two electric charges reduces to a quarter of its former value when the distance between them is doubled?

(A) Pascal's Law
(B) Coulomb's Law
(C) Stefan's Law
(D) Hooke's Law

Q.11
Archaeologist R Nagaswamy was honoured at the Silver Jubilee International Conference of Art by which country?

(A) Bhutan
(B) Bangladesh
(C) China
(D) Nepal

Q.12
Who became the first Indian equestrian to qualify for the Tokyo Olympics 2020?

(A) Amit Sinsinwar
(B) Amar Sarin
(C) Fouaad Mirza
(D) Sehej Singh Virk

Q.13
In which of the following states is the Madhavpur Mela celebrated?

(A) Uttar Pradesh
(B) Bihar
(C) Madhya Pradesh
(D) Gujarat

Q.14
Which state's Legislative Assembly adopted a new logo consisting of the national emblem and foxtail orchid (Rhynchostylis Retusa), the state flower, in January 2020?

(A) Mizoram
(B) Meghalaya
(C) Tripura
(D) Arunachal Pradesh

Q.15
Which of the following festivals means 'Merry making of the Gods'?

(A) Lai Haraoba
(B) Pongal
(C) Diwali
(D) Makar Sankranti

Q.16
Which of the following glands is present between the lungs?

(A) Pineal
(B) Thymus
(C) Hypothalamus
(D) Pituitary

Q.17
In which of the following countries was the 95th edition of the prestigious Hastings International Chess Congress held?

(A) France
(B) England
(C) Belgium
(D) Australia

Q.18
In which state was the Global Investors Meet, ASCEND 2020 organised?

(A) Kerala
(B) Gujarat
(C) Rajasthan
(D) Maharashtra

Q.19
In which year was the foundation stone for the Gateway of India laid in Bombay (now Mumbai)?

(A) 1905
(B) 1913
(C) 1915
(D) 1920

Q.20
Wings India 2020 is scheduled to be held in which of the following airports?

(A) Begumpet Airport
(B) Warangal Airport
(C) Vijayawada Airport
(D) Rajahmundry Airport

Q.21
When we cut an onion, the synthase enzyme converts the amino acid sulfoxides of the onion into which acid?

(A) Nitric acid
(B) Sulphuric acid
(C) Citric acid
(D) Sulfenic acid

Q.22
Who among the following was honoured with the 50th Dadasaheb Phalke Award?

(A) Amitabh Bachchan
(B) Naseeruddin Shah
(C) Anupam Kher
(D) Kamal Haasan

Q.23
Which of the following is NOT a vertebrate?

(A) Snail
(B) Bird
(C) Fish
(D) Mammal

Q.24
In which district of Karnataka is the Brahmagiri Wildlife Sanctuary located?

(A) Hassan
(B) Mandya
(C) Kodagu
(D) Udupi

Q.25
Which of the following is the major component of vinegar?

(A) Acetic acid
(B) Nitric acid
(C) Lactic acid
(D) Citric acid

English Comprehension 24 questions

Q.1
Select the most appropriate word to substitute the underlined word of the given sentence. If no substitution is required, select 'No improvement'. There is a great "degrade in values" in modern age.

(A) degradation of values
(B) demonstration from values
(C) No improvement
(D) deliberation for values

Q.2
Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence. He said to me, "What are you doing?"

(A) He asked me what I was doing.
(B) He said that what I was doing.
(C) He said what I had been doing.
(D) He asked me that what was I doing.

Q.3
Select the synonym of the given word. PATHETIC

(A) Insignificant
(B) Pitiful
(C) Dull
(D) Curious

Q.4
In the sentence identify the segment which contains the grammatical error. The modern man is busy acquiring more and more wealth and designing ways to invest it in more sense pleasures.

(A) acquiring more and more wealth
(B) designing ways to invest it
(C) modern man is busy
(D) in more sense pleasures

Q.5

Select the antonym of the given word. HILARIOUS

(A) Sad
(B) Blithe
(C) Happy
(D) Merry

Q.6

Select the most appropriate word to fill in the blank. It is an _____ day to start your new business.

(A) audacious
(B) ominous
(C) occasional
(D) auspicious

Q.7

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. Machines were made to be man's servants. Yet, man has grown so (1)_____ on them that they are in a fair way to become his (2)_____. Already men spend most of their lives looking after and waiting (3)_____ machines. Machines are very stern bosses. They must be fed with coal and (4)_____ petrol to drink and oil to wash with and must be kept at an (5)_____ temperature.

Select the most appropriate option for blank no. 1

(A) dependent
(B) subordinate
(C) inferior
(D) helpless

Q.8

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. Machines were made to be man's servants. Yet, man has grown so (1)_____ on them that they are in a fair way to become his (2)_____. Already men spend most of their lives looking after and waiting (3)_____ machines. Machines are very stern bosses. They must be fed with coal and (4)_____ petrol to drink and oil to wash with and must be kept at an (5)_____ temperature.

Select the most appropriate option for blank no. 2

(A) slaves
(B) administrators
(C) masters
(D) victims

Q.9

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. Machines were made to be man's servants. Yet, man has grown so (1)_____ on them that they are in a fair way to become his (2)_____. Already men spend most of their lives looking after and waiting (3)_____ machines. Machines are very stern bosses. They must be fed with coal and (4)_____ petrol to drink and oil to wash with and must be kept at an (5)_____ temperature.

Select the most appropriate option for blank no. 3

(A) upon
(B) into
(C) from
(D) under

Q.10

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. Machines were made to be man's servants. Yet, man has grown so (1)_____ on them that they are in a fair way to become his (2)_____. Already men spend most of their lives looking after and waiting (3)_____ machines. Machines are very stern bosses. They must be fed with coal and (4)_____ petrol to drink and oil to wash with and must be kept at an (5)_____ temperature.

Select the most appropriate option for blank no. 4

(A) give
(B) given
(C) gives
(D) gave

Q.11

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. Machines were made to be man's servants. Yet, man has grown so (1)_____ on them that they are in a fair way to become his (2)_____. Already men spend most of their lives looking after and waiting (3)_____ machines. Machines are very stern bosses. They must be fed with coal and (4)_____ petrol to drink and oil to wash with and must be kept at an (5)_____ temperature.

Select the most appropriate option for blank no. 5

(A) optimist
(B) optional
(C) outdated
(D) optimum

Q.12

Given below are four jumbled sentences. Out of the given options pick the one that gives their correct order. A. Can I borrow your camera? B. I will give it back to you next week. C. I am going to jungle safari tomorrow. D. My friend told me that jungle is beautiful in these days.

(A) BACD
(B) CDAB
(C) ADBC
(D) CADB

Q.13

Select the most appropriate segment to substitute the underlined segment of the given sentence. If no substitution is required select 'No improvement' A man in need "pleaded for help."

(A) No improvement
(B) promised for help
(C) requested for helping
(D) commanded to help

Q.14

Select the correct active form of the given sentence. The thief was being arrested by the police.

(A) The police has arrested the thief.
(B) The police arrested the thief.
(C) The police had arrested the thief.
(D) The police was arresting the thief.

Q.15

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom A snake in the grass

(A) A well-wisher
(B) Difficult to find
(C) A secret enemy
(D) A good friend

Q.16

Select the synonym of the given word. PENITENCE

(A) Repentance
(B) Misery
(C) Patience
(D) Admiration

Q.17

Select the antonym of the given word. VICIOUS

(A) Baneful
(B) Virtuous
(C) Sinful
(D) Unfortunate

Q.18

Select one word for the following group of words. A period of ten years

(A) Millennium
(B) Century
(C) Decade
(D) Fortnight

Q.19

Given below are four jumbled sentences. Out of the given options pick the one that gives their correct order. A. Nevertheless, sound health, economic security and mental satisfaction are desired by all B. A change that is conducive to happiness may be termed as progress. C. But different people find happiness in different things. D. So, If a change contributes to the growth of these factors, it is progress.

(A) BDCA
(B) DBCA
(C) BCAD
(D) ABCD

Q.20

Select the wrongly spelt word.

(A) Elegant
(B) Flashy
(C) Practicle
(D) Flexible

Q.22

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom On shank's mare

(A) On an elephant
(B) On a lion
(C) On a bicycle
(D) On foot

Q.23

Select the most appropriate word to fill in the blank. He _____ a heinous crime.

(A) happened
(B) committed
(C) occurred
(D) made

Q.24

In the sentence identify the segment which contains the grammatical error. The Prime Minister, along with the other ministers have left for America.

(A) The Prime Minister along with
(B) the other ministers
(C) for America
(D) have left

Q.25

Select one word for the following group of words. One who leaves his own country to settle in another

(A) Foreigner
(B) Emigrant
(C) Native
(D) Tourist

Answer key

General Awareness

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(B)**
Q.7 **(C)**	Q.8 **(C)**	Q.9 **(C)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(C)**
Q.13 **(D)**	Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(A)**	Q.16 **(B)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(A)**
Q.19 **(B)**	Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.22 **(A)**	Q.23 **(A)**	Q.24 **(C)**
Q.25 **(A)**					

English Comprehension

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(D)**
Q.7 **(A)**	Q.8 **(C)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.12 **(B)**
Q.13 **(A)**	Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.16 **(A)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(C)**
Q.19 **(C)**	Q.20 **(C)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(D)**	Q.25 **(B)**

Explanations

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (A) Seventh

In Brand Finance's Nation Brands 2019 ranking India rose two places, from ninth to seventh, with a brand value of about US$2.6 trillion.

Q.2 · Answer (A) Dhanananda

Dhanananda was the last Nanda king of Magadha; Chandragupta Maurya, with Chanakya's help, overthrew him and founded the Maurya empire.

Q.3 · Answer (A) Lodhi Gardens

Lodhi Gardens in New Delhi, around the tombs of the Sayyid and Lodi rulers, was laid out in 1936 as Lady Willingdon Park, after the Viceroy's wife, and renamed after independence.

Q.4 · Answer (B) IIT Kanpur

In September 2019 the Ministry of Railways and the Department of Science and Technology launched an 'Industry 4.0' pilot project with IIT Kanpur at the Modern Coach Factory, Raebareli.

Q.5 · Answer (B) Narendra Modi

'Karmayoddha Granth', released by Amit Shah in New Delhi on 7 January 2020, is a book on the life of Narendra Modi, Prime Minister when the exam was held (March 2020).

Q.6 · Answer (B) Bimbisara

Ajatashatru succeeded his father Bimbisara on the throne of Magadha; Udayin was Ajatashatru's own son and successor.

Q.7 · Answer (C) Gujarat

In January 2020 KVIC opened Gujarat's first silk processing plant, at Surendranagar, to bring down the cost of silk yarn for Patola weavers.

Q.8 · Answer (C) Ananthagiri Hill

The Borra Caves lie in the Ananthagiri Hills of the Araku Valley in Andhra Pradesh, in the Eastern Ghats; the area was in Visakhapatnam district when the exam was held (March 2020) and has been in Alluri Sitharama Raju district since 2022.

Q.9 · Answer (C) celestial bodies

The sun, the moon and all the objects that shine in the night sky are called celestial bodies.

Q.10 · Answer (B) Coulomb's Law

By Coulomb's law the force between two charges varies inversely as the square of the distance between them, so doubling the distance cuts it to $1/2^2 = 1/4$.

Q.11 · Answer (B) Bangladesh

SSC's key gives Bangladesh: the Tamil Nadu archaeologist R Nagaswamy is reported to have been honoured in Dhaka at the Silver Jubilee International Conference of Art. (We could not confirm the honour from an independent source.)

Q.12 · Answer (C) Fouaad Mirza

Fouaad Mirza won India an individual eventing place at the Tokyo Olympics, the first Indian equestrian to qualify for the Games since 2000.

Q.13 · Answer (D) Gujarat

The Madhavpur Ghed fair, at Madhavpur near Porbandar in Gujarat, celebrates the marriage of Krishna and Rukmini.

Q.14 · Answer (D) Arunachal Pradesh

In January 2020 the Arunachal Pradesh Legislative Assembly adopted a new logo pairing the national emblem with the foxtail orchid, Arunachal's state flower.

Q.15 · Answer (A) Lai Haraoba

Lai Haraoba, Manipur's festival of the traditional Meitei deities (the Umang Lai), means 'merrymaking of the gods'.

Q.16 · Answer (B) Thymus

The thymus lies in the chest, behind the breastbone and between the lungs; the pineal gland, the hypothalamus and the pituitary are in the brain.

Q.17 · Answer (B) England
The Hastings International Chess Congress is held in its home town, Hastings, on the south coast of England.

Q.18 · Answer (A) Kerala
Ascend Kerala 2020, the Kerala government's global investors' meet, was held in Kochi in January 2020.

Q.19 · Answer (B) 1913
The foundation stone of the Gateway of India, built to mark the 1911 visit of King George V and Queen Mary, was laid in March 1913; the arch was completed in 1924.

Q.20 · Answer (A) Begumpet Airport
Wings India, the civil aviation show organised by the Ministry of Civil Aviation, the Airports Authority of India and FICCI, is held at Begumpet Airport in Hyderabad; the 2020 edition was set for 12 to 15 March 2020.

Q.21 · Answer (D) Sulfenic acid
Cutting an onion lets the enzyme alliinase turn its amino acid sulfoxides into sulfenic acids; lachrymatory-factor synthase, the enzyme the question names, then turns the sulfenic acid into the volatile compound that makes the eyes water.

Q.22 · Answer (A) Amitabh Bachchan
Amitabh Bachchan received the 50th Dadasaheb Phalke Award, for 2018, announced in September 2019.

Q.23 · Answer (A) Snail
A snail is a mollusc and has no backbone; birds, fish and mammals are vertebrates.

Q.24 · Answer (C) Kodagu
Brahmagiri Wildlife Sanctuary lies in Kodagu (Coorg) district, on Karnataka's border with Kerala.

Q.25 · Answer (A) Acetic acid
Vinegar is a dilute solution of acetic (ethanoic) acid in water.

English Comprehension

Q.1 · Answer (A) degradation of values
After 'a great' the sentence needs a noun, and 'degrade' is a verb: 'There is a great degradation of values in modern age.'

Q.2 · Answer (A) He asked me what I was doing.
A reported question takes 'asked', drops the question order and shifts the tense back: 'He asked me what I was doing.'

Q.3 · Answer (B) Pitiful
'Pathetic' means arousing pity: 'pitiful'.

Q.4 · Answer (D) in more sense pleasures
SSC's key gives 'in more sense pleasures', taking the noun 'sense' to need an adjective: 'sensual' (or 'sensuous') pleasures. The other three segments are correct as they stand, though 'sense pleasures' (pleasures of the senses) is itself in use.

Q.5 · Answer (A) Sad
'Hilarious' means extremely funny; its opposite is 'sad'. 'Blithe', 'happy' and 'merry' are close in meaning.

Q.6 · Answer (D) auspicious
'Auspicious' means promising good fortune, the right word for a day to start a business; 'ominous' means the opposite.

Q.7 · Answer (A) dependent
Man has grown so 'dependent' on machines that they may become his masters; 'dependent' is the word that takes 'on'.

Q.8 · Answer (C) masters
Made to be man's servants, machines are on the way to becoming his 'masters'; the next sentences call them stern bosses.

Q.9 · Answer (A) upon
To 'wait upon' is to serve: men spend their lives looking after and serving machines.

Q.10 · Answer (B) given
The passive continues from 'must be fed': machines must be fed coal and 'given' petrol to drink.

Q.11 · Answer (D) optimum
'Optimum' means best or most favourable: machines must be kept at the right temperature.

Q.12 · Answer (B) CDAB
C says where the speaker is going, D why a camera is wanted (the jungle is beautiful), A asks for the camera and B promises to return it: CDAB.

Q.13 · Answer (A) No improvement
To 'plead for' something is to ask for it earnestly, so the sentence is correct as it stands.

Q.14 · Answer (D) The police was arresting the thief.
SSC's key gives the only option that keeps the tense: the past continuous passive 'was being arrested' becomes the past continuous active. Strictly, 'the police' takes a plural verb ('The police were arresting the thief.'), but no option has that, and the other three change the tense.

Q.15 · Answer (C) A secret enemy
A 'snake in the grass' is a treacherous person who pretends to be a friend: a secret enemy.

Q.16 · Answer (A) Repentance
'Penitence' is sorrow for having done wrong: 'repentance'.

Q.17 · Answer (B) Virtuous
'Vicious' means cruel or wicked; its opposite is 'virtuous'. 'Baneful' and 'sinful' are close in meaning.

Q.18 · Answer (C) Decade
A decade is ten years; a century is a hundred, a millennium a thousand, and a fortnight two weeks.

Q.19 · Answer (C) BCAD
B defines progress through happiness, C notes that people find happiness in different things, A ('Nevertheless') names what all desire and D ('So') concludes: BCAD.

Q.20 · Answer (C) Practicle
The correct spelling is 'practical'.

Q.22 · Answer (D) On foot
To go 'on shank's mare' is to walk, the shank being the leg: on foot.

Q.23 · Answer (B) committed
One 'commits' a crime; 'happen' and 'occur' take no object, and one does not 'make' a crime.

Q.24 · Answer (D) have left
With 'along with', the verb agrees with the first subject, 'The Prime Minister': 'has left', not 'have left'.

Q.25 · Answer (B) Emigrant
An emigrant leaves his own country to settle in another; seen from the new country, the same person is an immigrant.

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